



Discussion Guide: Luke Powery

“An Ethics of Dust”

Reflect

- Luke’s opening story recalls a time when he was asked, “What color is your mother?” Share your reaction to this story. How did it make you feel and what did it help you become aware of? Has a similar question ever been put to you? If so, what were the circumstances?
- Luke reminds us that the Spirit of God that has been breathed into each of us is colorless. In your view, do you think this means we all should strive to be “colorblind” when it comes to relating to people of different races? Why or why not?
- Genesis 3:19 tells us “you are dust, and to dust you will return.” Describe how Luke’s TheoEd talk has changed the way you understand this verse. How, in your view, might an understanding of our common mortality be helpful to some of the divides and divisions we face in our world today?

Respond

- In Acts 2, the Spirit enables those who had gathered in Jerusalem for Pentecost to hear the disciples speaking in their own native language. In this sense, those at the center (the disciples) accommodate to those on the margins. In your own community, where do you see the reverse happening – i.e., those on the margins being asked to accommodate to those at the center? What are the results?
- Luke’s suggests that embracing an “ethics of dust” demands humility, which leads us to ask questions rather than pronounce judgment. How can a commitment to asking questions about ourselves, our neighbors, or our context lead to less judgmental attitudes? Describe a time when you have seen this at work in your own life.

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